

Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita

"The Nectar of Sri Krishna Chaitanya's Acts" (Murari Gupta's *Kadacha*)

Murari Gupta

Translated from the Sanskrit into English

Translator's Note

Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita is the Sanskrit poem of Murari Gupta, a fellow-countryman and companion of

Sri Chaitanya and an eyewitness of his life in Navadvipa; tradition calls it Murari Gupta's *Kadacha* ("notes"). It

is the earliest biography of Mahaprabhu, drawn upon by Vrindavana Dasa, Kavikarnapura, Lochana Dasa and Krishnadasa

Kaviraja. The poem is divided into four *prakramas* (parts) and 78 *sargas* (cantos).

Source. The Sanskrit text has been reconstructed from three OCR copies: two scans of the edition of Haridasa

Shastri (Vrindavana) and the edition of Haridasa Dasa (Calcutta, 1945, Bengali script); readings were checked against

metre and grammar. Verse numbering follows Haridasa Shastri's edition. Only Murari Gupta's Sanskrit text has been

translated; the translations and commentaries of the editions were not used. Interpretation follows Srila Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati.

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Prakrama One

Prakrama 1, Sarga 1. The Sequence of the Descent

Benediction; the appearance of Vishvambhara; Srivasa bids Murari tell of the Lord; Navadvipa and its devotees; Jagannatha Mishra

1. Glory to Him whose prowess is utterly pure, who shines like gold, whose eyes are wide as lotus petals, whose fine arms reach down to His knees, who in many ways dances in the rasa of devotion!
2. The son of Jagannatha, the Lord of the world, the origin of the world, the remover of the world's distress, the all-powerful, the protector in the Kali age, the remover of the burden of Kali — He was born of Shachi, bearing with Him devotion to Himself.
3. Hari, welcomed by the best of the twice-born in the lands of Navadvipa, giving joy to His parents and living happily at home, —
4. studied the Veda with its six limbs¹, dwelling in the house of His guru, devoted to serving him and pure in His vows. And He, Hari, called Vishvambhara, so that the righteous might follow the dharma of this age, —
5. enjoined the kirtana of Hari, remembering that it is supremely dear to Hari and is the highest goal of human life. Performing the rite for His ancestors in Gaya, in the lands marked by Hari's feet, He Himself —
6. from the mere treasure of remembering Himself, became stunned with love, the hair of His body standing on end. Then, at the word of a bodiless voice², He returned to His own home.
7. The Lord, surrounded by the foremost of His devotees — He whose form was full of ripened love, the crusher of the lion-like Danavas — rejoiced in the happiness of the kirtana of Hari and of holy talks about Him.
8. Then, so that thirsting ears might plunge into the fame of Him whose glory is generous — a nectar for the ears of the virtuous — one whose eyes trembled with tears of joy took up this splendid, auspicious and true narrative³.
9. A devotee named Srivasa, the sun that makes the lotus of the twice-born race bloom, said to Sri Murari: "Tell here a new, holy account of the life of Hari." Accepting his command and bowing to him again and again with openly joined palms, Murari himself began to tell the glory of Sriman Chaitanya, which takes away the stain of Kali.
10. Then Murari, the physician's son, reflected: "How shall I tell the auspicious story of Chaitanya, so rich in meaning,
11. which even Vachaspati⁴ himself cannot tell? Yet it is fitting to carry out the command of a Vaishnava — so my mind resolves.
12. It shines ever pure through the treasure of remembering Krishna; the Vaishnava's command will surely bear fruit, and not otherwise."
13. Having said this, he began to tell the story enriched with devotion to Bhagavan — for dharma, wealth and desire, for liberation, and for devotion to Vishnu.
14. I bow to Chaitanya — the unborn, the primeval, the four-armed, bearing conch, mace, lotus and disc — to Hari, whose chest is marked with the sign of Shrivatsa, with a gem upon His fair forehead, finely clad.

15. I shall tell something of the stories of Bhagavan for the delight of the virtuous. And if some slip should occur, then to correct it here is the task of the greatest souls, who do good to others: they alone are the authority in this.
16. In the holy place known as Navadvipa, supremely Vaishnava, there lived brahmanas — saintly, peaceful, Vaishnavas, born in good families,
17. great, skilled in rites, all masters of the meaning of the scriptures; and there are also many other people there — physicians, shudras and merchants.
18. All of them are devoted to their own duties and pure, all live by learning; all of them there have vowed themselves to God — in that place which is like the abode of Vaikuntha.
19. There shone Srivasa, an intoxicated bee sporting at the lotus feet of Hari: moist with love, his arms flung up⁵, ever eager, he sings of the Lord in the rapture of the highest rasa. There too was Gopinatha⁶, foremost of the twice-born: as soon as the name of Krishna reached his ears, he, intoxicated, wept aloud again and again and danced beyond measure, his hands quivering in rhythm.
20. There shone the master, the great soul, the excellent Sri Advaita — radiant as the rising morning sun, skilled in awakening the lotuses of the hearts of the wise; like the moon born of the ocean of compassion, the very embodiment of cooling the burning in people's hearts; unsurpassed in loving meditation, rich in the fine gift of the art of dance, a teacher of the art of the highest rasa.
21. There shone brightly the teacher Chandrashekhara, endowed with every virtue, the king of the twice-born⁷; at the name of Krishna the hair of his body stood on end, and he was wet with streaming tears.
22. There, when the sage Haridasa dances, the Lord of the world, out of love for His servant, joyfully watches that dance together with the hosts of gods led by Mahesha, moving through the sky.
23. There flows the river born from Vishnu's foot, swift and wholly moist with compassion, who, vying with the Yamuna, daughter of the Sun, and with the Sarayu, bore Hari shining like gold⁸.
24. In that place lived Jagannatha, like the moon in the ocean of the twice-born race, a teacher of the Vedas, endowed with all virtues, equal to Brihaspati. Pure in mind through the mighty yoga of meditation on Krishna's feet, moist with love, he grew swiftly like the crescent of the new moon.

Thus ends the first sarga, "The Sequence of the Descent," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Chaitanya-charita."

1. The six angas (auxiliary disciplines) of the Veda: phonetics, ritual, grammar, etymology, metrics and astronomy.
2. The "bodiless voice" (asharira vak) is a voice from the sky, heard without a visible speaker.
3. The subject is not named; to judge from the next verse, it is the poet himself, Murari Gupta.
4. Vachaspati ("lord of speech") is Brihaspati, the preceptor of the gods, the model of eloquence.
5. The beginning of the second line of this verse is damaged in the sources; "his arms flung up" is a reading restored by the metre.
6. Gopinatha is a brahmana of Navadvipa; apparently Gopinatha Acharya, who later appears in Nilachala.
7. "King of the twice-born" (dvija-raj) is also a poetic name of the moon — a play on the name Chandrashekhara ("Crowned with the Moon").
8. On the banks of the Yamuna Krishna played, on the banks of the Sarayu (in Ayodhya) Rama; the Ganga at Navadvipa has received Gaura.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 2. Narada's Sorrow

Jagannatha Mishra and Shachi; the birth of Vishvarupa; Damodara Pandita's question; Narada sees the earth gripped by Kali

1. Then his guru, knower of the truth, conferred on him, who knew the meaning of all the scriptures, the title "Shriman Mishra Purandara"¹.
2. Once the illustrious and great-minded Nilambara, called Chakravarti, summoned this learned man of noble family, the best of the righteous,
3. and gave him his daughter Shachi in marriage — he, the support of his line²; and having won her, Mishra prospered, like Purandara having won Shachi³.
4. From then on, as he lived at home, his dharma grew — through hospitality, propitiatory rites, purifications, and the fruits of regular and optional rites.
5. In the course of time eight lovely daughters were born to him one after another, and by fate they all died. Shachi —
6. her mind burning with the grief of a mother's love, took refuge in Hari in her heart, praying for a son; and the illustrious Mishra performed a sacrifice to the ancestors.
7. After some time he obtained a son like a son of the gods, and Jagannatha rejoiced like a poor man who has found a treasure.
8. The father gave the illustrious boy the name Vishvarupa. In a very short time that great soul studied
9. the Vedas and the science of logic, and became known as excellent, endowed with true yoga. He was all-knowing, wise, peaceful, and a benefactor of all.
10. Always intent on meditating on Hari, he did not turn his mind to the objects of the senses, and was ceaselessly intoxicated with tasting the rasa of the Srimad-Bhagavatam.
11. As his younger brother the Lord Himself was born — the unborn source of the world — just as Upendra, the younger brother of Indra, was born the son of Kashyapa and Aditi⁴.
12. He Himself made the three worlds devoted to the sankirtana of Hari; having lived in the foremost of holy places, called Purushottama,
13. practising devotion to Hari and teaching it to the people, having tasted the sweetness of Sri Vrindavana and giving the people to taste it,
14. having delivered the whole world — He, honoured by the dwellers of Vaikuntha, joyfully went to His very own abode, full of great splendour.
15. Hearing of this wonder, the brahmachari who had conquered his senses, intoxicated with the stories of Sri Chaitanya — Sri Damodara Pandita⁵ — said:
16. "Tell the divine, wondrous story that purifies the world, by hearing which people are freed from samsara and from dreadful sin.
17. Through it the supreme treasures of love for the lotus feet of Sri Krishna arise in all people; so tell the story of Hari.
18. For what reason was He, the all-powerful Lord of all, born on earth? What did He, the Lord of the worlds, do here?
19. Please tell of His auspicious and blessed deeds — for relieving the distress of the worlds, and for the love of the very great souls."
20. Hearing these words of the great-souled pandita, Murari was pleased and said: "Listen!
21. Well, O best of the twice-born, I shall tell you as far as I am able — in brief, for even Bhargava⁶ could not tell it in full.

22. Once Narada, the righteous soul, foremost of the Vaishnavas, of great power, radiant as the full moon — in the land called Bharata —
23. white as the peak of Kailasa, adorned with a fine girdle, wearing a deerskin, a portion of Vishnu, dear to all people —
24. was wandering through the vault of the sky for the good of all, joyfully sounding his Mahati⁷, which sings forth the name of Hari.
25. 'Where shall I see a Vaishnava? There I shall now dwell' — thinking thus, he surveyed this earth with his mind,
26. and saw that Kali, the friend of sin, had muddied the wide earth with filth, and that the earth-cow herself was in the hands of the mlechchhas and drained by cruel taxes⁸.
27. And he saw there people beset by sins and diseases, given to slandering others, deceitful, short-lived and emaciated;
28. he saw kings skilled in sin, shudras, villainous Yavanas, mlechchhas given to forbidden deeds, robbing their subjects of all they had,
29. and even men learned in scripture — proud, and reviling the saints. Seeing all these many kinds of people, Narada fell to pondering.

Thus ends the second sarga, "Narada's Sorrow," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charita."

1. Purandara ("Destroyer of Strongholds") is a name of Indra; hence the wordplay in v. 3, since Indra's consort is also named Shachi.
2. The epithet kulakricchadah is the same in all the sources, but its meaning is unclear; the translation is conjectural.
3. That is, like Indra, who won his consort Shachi.
4. Upendra is Vishnu as Vamana, born of the sage Kashyapa and Aditi as Indra's younger brother.
5. From this verse the poem is framed as a dialogue: Damodara Pandita asks, and Murari tells.
6. Bhargava is Shukra, the preceptor of the asuras, famed for his wisdom.
7. The Mahati is Narada's vina.
8. A play on words: go means both "earth" and "cow"; kara means both "tax" and "ray" (the earth is parched as if by scorching rays). Mlechchhas and Yavanas are foreigners outside Vedic dharma; the Muslim rulers of Bengal are meant.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 3. Narada's Inquiry

Narada goes to Vaikuntha; the vision of Vaikuntha and of Krishna; Narada pleads for the world perishing in Kali; the Lord agrees to descend

1. "In the first twilight of Kali¹ this earth has sunk (into sin). For all who are scorched by sin the name of Hari is the healing elixir;
2. it surely becomes a deliverer — for all except those who hate the Vaishnavas: except the self-conceited and except the revilers of the Vaishnavas.
3. But those dull-witted ones who would revile the name of Krishna and His forms, saying, 'They are not eternal'² — for them there is only hell.
4. What remedy can there be here?" Having pondered this, the sage, pure of mind, a treasury of compassion, went to the supreme abode called Vaikuntha.
5. And the sage saw Vaikuntha, sung by the three Vedas, the undivided abode, which by its own radiance has dispelled the dust (of rajas) in every quarter — and he attained a state beyond the gunas.

6. There swarms of bees sing Hari's fame among rows of lotuses; it is adorned with ponds lovely with jewelled banks and fragrant with hanging creepers;
7. in it are ruby houses with turrets adorned with strings of pearls from the heads of lordly elephants³; in it are trees that bear in every season; it resounds with the song of birds and is rich in paths of moonstone.
8. There he saw the unborn, the primeval one, attended by Shri — He whose locks are lit by the radiance of a gleaming crown, whose eyes surpass blooming celestial lotuses, whose fair, shining face the very moon worships;
9. whose cheeks are graced by gleaming great earrings, whose neck is fine as a conch, whose garments shine like gold — Krishna, with four arms like door-bars, like a blue mountain peak with wish-fulfilling trees;
10. resplendent with golden armlets and other ornaments, with strings of pearls and fine golden cords; He whose hips shine with a cloth bound by a net of little bells; He whose feet are beautiful lotuses.
11. Inhaling the charming fragrance of His lotus feet, the sage — with tears of joy, his hair standing on end — at once fell to the ground near Krishna like a rod, as if senseless.
12. Then the grateful Lord at once stretched out His hand, the radiance of whose nails was variegated by jewelled rings, joyfully touched the sage's head and, His face graced by a gentle smile, spoke charmingly:
13. "Rise, O son of the Self-born⁴, O sage, O great soul! Whatever you tell Me today, that I shall do for you. For My time has come of itself — the time when, in the ages, the righteous must practise dharma."
14. Then Hari, wholly devoted to the greatest souls, raised up the best of the great rishis and at once showed him a seat, and at Hari's command the sage sat down.
15. Then Bhagavan asked: "O sage, why have you come here to Me? What is your wish? Though I am complete, let Me do your task, O holy one: the deeds of the great are for the good of others."
16. Hearing such nectarean words from Krishna, the ocean of the nectar of mercy, words that sounded like a rain-laden cloud, and (encouraged) by Hari's glance full of smiles, the sage said: "I bow to You! Protect the suffering worlds!
17. Now, O mighty one, the earth is wasting away in distress, bearing people laden with floods of sin. And all the people, bitten by the time of Kali, delight in sin and have abandoned talk of You.
18. Protect them, O Master: apart from You they have no other protector from hell, no other good refuge. Having considered this, act, O Lord of all worlds: You Yourself are the good refuge, O Lord, and no other."
19. Having heard these words of the sage, Hari, though He knew all, said: "What shall I do? By what means can peace come? Tell Me." And the son of the Self-born spoke to Him again:
20. "Descend Yourself, cooling as a hundred moons, in a lineage of brahmanas, in a good family of the Vatsya line⁵; win renown as 'the son of Jagannatha,' and bring welfare to the earth.
21. What You did, O Bhagavan, in the forms of Rama and others — the slaying of sinful Rakshasas and Danavas and the like — that is not to be done here: purify the minds of men.
22. 'If I kill those who have fallen into the demoniac state, where then will the world be?' — resolving thus in Your own mind, make Your glory known, and may the people be happy.
23. And there too, together with Rudra, the foremost of sages would descend to help You"⁶. "So be it," Hari said to the divine rishi; and he, bowing, at once departed joyfully.

Thus ends the third sarga, "Narada's Inquiry," of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charita."

1. The "twilight" (sandhya) is the opening period of a yuga; the Kali age has only just begun.
 2. The Lord's name and form are eternal and not material; to call them non-eternal is an offence.
 3. According to poetic convention, pearls form in the heads of lordly elephants.
 4. Narada is the son of Brahma, the Self-born (Svayambhu).
 5. Vatsya is the brahmana clan (gotra) to which Jagannatha Mishra belonged.
 6. Which gods and sages descended together with the Lord is told in the next sarga.
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Prakrama 1, Sarga 4. On the Descents

The Lord's companions as portions of the Lord, of gods and of sages; the story of Haridasa; the two kinds of avatara: the avatars of the ages and the avatars for a particular purpose

1. Having heard all this, Sri Damodara Pandita, greatly pleased, said: "Tell, then, the story of Nrihari¹.
2. Who, in these descents, came down to the earth? And of how many kinds are the descents? Tell me of them in order."
3. Hearing these words of the foremost of the twice-born, Sri Murari said respectfully and with great affection: "Listen!
4. Now I shall tell you of something else — of the descent of Hari's own portions: of the devotees renowned as pure devotees, who are forms of the Lord.
5. First was born the best of the twice-born, the master Sri Madhava Puri. A portion of the Lord, dividing in two, (appeared as him) and as Advaita Acharya, endowed with good qualities².
6. The disciple of them both was the divine Chandrashekhara, a portion of the Moon; of great fame, he is renowned on earth as Acharyaratna.
7. Sriman Srivasa Pandita was born as a portion of Sri Narada; Sri Mukunda of the Vaidya (physician) caste, the fine singer, was a portion of a Gandharva.
8. Sriman Sri Haridasa was a portion of a sage. Hear how this was once told by a brahmana bitten by a snake³.
9. Formerly there lived in Dravida, in a Vaishnava holy place, an illustrious, excellent sage named Rama, a great ascetic, who loved his son dearly.
10. His son washed tulasi leaves and placed them in a clean vessel, but they fell on the ground, and without washing them again
11. he gave them to his father; and he, the great sage named Sri Rama, offered them to Bhagavan. For that reason he was born in a Yavana (Muslim) family.
12. He is righteous, wise, peaceful and versed in all knowledge; he is also a portion of Brahma⁴ — and therefore the illustrious Haridasa is, beyond doubt, a true devotee.
13. The Avadhuta Nityananda, of great power, the greatest, was born as a portion of Baladeva; he is the great yogi, the Lord Himself.
14. I do not venture to describe his family, character and deeds: even Brihaspati himself, in a hundred years,
15. could not tell of them — what then of others, of us petty creatures! He is the second form of Sri Krishna, dear to Gauranga as life itself.

16. And many others — hundreds of gods and eminent sages — were born on earth as portions; I do not venture to enumerate them.
17. Next: it is declared that the descents of the Purusha are of two kinds. The first is the avatara of the age (yuga-avatara); the second appears for a particular task.
18. Those are called avataras of the ages who appear in age after age and establish dharma. Hear of them in order.
19. In the Satya age meditation alone brings a man to the goal. For this purpose the White One descended, four-armed, with matted locks;
20. like a thousand moons, a sage always absorbed in meditation, He became the teacher of meditation for all living beings.
21. In the Treta age the one dharma that achieves every aim is sacrifice. Then Yajna Himself was born, with the sacrificial ladles and the other implements.
22. Together with brahmanas who performed sacrifice, He, Janardana, the enjoyer of sacrifice, the Victorious One, Himself performed sacrifice and taught it to all the people.
23. In the Dvapara age worship is ordained for attaining the goal of life. Knowing this, Vishnu Himself appeared in the form of Prithu⁵.
24. Righteous, He performed worship and instructed the people in it, and the minds of all turned to worship.
25. But in Kali the highest good is kirtana — the dharma that benefits all, full of all powers, directly bestowing the highest bliss.
26. Having resolved thus in His mind, Sri Chaitanya Mahaprabhu Himself was born on earth, bringing happiness to the saintly.
27. Full of joy, He Himself performed kirtana and caused others to perform it. These are the avataras of the ages. Hear now of the others — those who descend for a particular task.
28. As the Fish — the rescue of the Vedas; as the Tortoise — the bearing of Mount Mandara; as the Boar — the lifting up of the earth; as Narasimha — the tearing apart (of Hiranyakashipu);
29. as Vamana He took for Himself the sovereignty of the worlds from the king of the Danavas; and Bhargava⁶ conquered the earth, defeating the arrogant kings,
30. and Vishnu, the sole deliverer of the world, gave that earth to a brahmana. As Sri Rama He slew Ravana, and the world was filled with His glory.
31. And in the descent of Sriman Krishna, Hari Himself, endowed with all powers, removed the burden of the earth.
32. As the Buddha the Supreme Bhagavan bewildered (people) regarding the Vedas, and in the form of Kalki He destroyed the mlechchhas.
33. Such are the many deeds of the many-formed Nrihari; the great rishis have described these avataras who descend for a particular task."

Thus ends the fourth sarga, "On the Descents" (Avataranukarana), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Nrihari ("Man-Hari") is usually a name of Nrisimha; here, as in v. 33, it names the Lord in general.
2. The sense is that a single portion of the Lord appeared in two ways — as Madhavendra Puri and as Advaita Acharya.
3. The brahmana's account itself is not given in the poem; Murari relates only its substance (vv. 9–11).
4. According to tradition, Haridasa is a portion of Brahma, who appeared as a devotee to atone for an offence.

5. The avatara of the Dvapara age is usually named otherwise; here Murari Gupta names Prithu, the king who first established the order of worship.

6. Bhargava is Parashurama, the descendant of Bhrigu.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 5. The Appearance of Sri Chaitanya

Shachi bears in her womb a portion of Hari; the hymn of the gods to Shachi; the Lord's birth on the full-moon night of Phalguna during a lunar eclipse; the prediction of Nilambara Chakravarti; the rites after the birth

1. "Hear attentively, O brahmana, the new story of the descent of Chaitanya — the all-powerful Lord of the world, the ocean of compassion.
2. When the best of the divine sages¹ had gone to his own hermitage, the Supreme Bhagavan Achyuta entered the mind of Jagannatha, the brahmana sage.
3. In due time the chaste wife received the great splendour he had placed in her. Thus the virtuous Shachi, devoted to her husband,
4. auspicious, conceived a child — a portion of Hari — as the Ganga once received the seed of Shambhu²; and her radiance waxed like the moon in the bright fortnight.
5. Seeing her beauty and her glow like molten gold, Jagannatha, graced with good fortune, rejoiced with all his heart.
6. Then, seeing her so, Brahma and the other gods, the Gandharvas, the immortals and the dwellers of the sky together with Indra
7. joined their palms in joy; with tears in their voices and eyes, their heads bowed in obeisance, they all joyfully sang her praise:
8. 'We bow to you who ever bear Him in your womb! You are Aditi, the mother of Hari; you bear in your womb the radiance of moon, sun and fire, you bear pure being in your womb; you are steadfastness and forbearance;
9. you bear freedom from malice in your womb; you are perfection; you bear in your womb the Veda — Hari Himself. You are Devaki, Rohini and Yashoda — in every guise the source of being³.
10. You bear in your womb Him who will spread the holiest of sacrifices — kirtana, whose fruit no (ordinary) sacrifice can attain.
11. Not even millions of sacrifices could give the joy that arises in such as us from half a moment of hearing the kirtana of Nrihari.
12. Oh! Great was the nectar of immortality that Hari Himself once gave after churning the ocean⁴ — yet a sweetness a million times greater
13. we taste here, hearing the glory of Sri Hari: for the sake of the kirtana of Hari the mind counts even liberation as nothing.'
14. Having spoken thus, the gods with Indra bowed to her and, placing Brahma at their head, departed, singing the glory of Sri Hari,
15. to their own city. Overjoyed that a portion of the Lord of Shri had been born on earth, they praised the good fortune of (the age of) Kali and danced, overwhelmed with love.
16. And then at midnight, in the auspicious month of Phalguna, when the moon, the lord of the night, was full, at an hour rich in every excellence and fanned by a pure breeze,

17. when the minds of the gods and the saints were serene and the waters of the heavenly river cool and pure — Hari Himself was born.
18. The son he had obtained was golden; His eyes were like blossoming lotuses, His face like the shining full moon, and by His own splendour He drove the darkness from every quarter.
19. And Sri Jagannatha Mishra Purandara, like a poor man who has found the padma treasure⁵, could not reach the further shore of his ocean of joy, and his voice kept faltering with love.
20. At the hour of His birth Rahu swallowed the moon entirely: defeated by the lotus face of Krishna, the moon, as if out of shame, hid in the mouth of the enemy of the gods⁶.
21. At that holy hour the people sang the kirtana of Narahari and offered worship, and then, keeping themselves pure, they bathed in the waters of the Jahnavi, gave gifts and performed the rite of cleansing from sin.
22. The hosts of gods with Mahendra, led by the Lotus-born and Mahesha, rejoiced; the apsaras gave themselves to dancing, and the leaders (of the Gandharvas) rained down flowers.
23. Delighted by His birth, Nilambara Chakravarti, the knower of all scriptures, hurried to the home of his son-in-law.
24. The wise man, who knew (from the stars) the hour of his grandson's birth, called Jagannatha and, addressing Shachi, spoke these words:
25. 'Oh! This lion among men is born when Brihaspati (Jupiter) stands in exaltation⁷. He will be the eternal protector of the whole world;
26. of noble character, the refuge of all dharmas, the best of sannyasis, He will gladden all beings like the full moon pouring nectar.
27. He will forever deliver both lineages — his father's and his mother's.' When the brahmana had spoken thus, all the people rejoiced.
28. Hearing these words of her father, the mother was filled with great joy, and the Vatsya⁸ held a great festival — the jatakarma, the birth rite of his son.
29. He gave the brahmanas betel, sandal paste, garlands and fragrances, and in due order performed the auspicious rites beginning with the utthana, the rite of "rising"⁹."

Thus ends the fifth sarga, "The Appearance of Sri Chaitanya" (Sri Chaitanya-avirbhava), of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Narada, at whose entreaty the Lord agreed to descend (Sarga 1.03).
2. An allusion to the birth of Skanda: the seed of Shiva (Shambhu) was received by the Ganga.
3. The reading of the last word of the verse is uncertain; the translation is tentative.
4. The churning of the Milk Ocean by the gods and asuras, from which the nectar of immortality (amrita) was obtained.
5. Padma is one of the nine treasures (nidhi) of Kubera.
6. The Lord's birth coincided with a lunar eclipse; Rahu is the demon, "the enemy of the gods," who swallows the moon.
7. The "exalted position" (uccha) of a planet in astrology is the sign of its greatest strength.
8. The Vatsya is Jagannatha Mishra, of the Vatsya clan.
9. Probably the rite marking the end of the lying-in period; another understanding is possible — the child's first standing up.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 6. The Description of the Pastimes from Birth among the Childhood Plays

Vishvambhara's infancy: the naming, His form, childhood plays; the wandering brahmana; the broken pots; the teaching on pure and impure; the brick thrown at His mother; the two coconuts; the sound of ankle bells

1. Some time passed, and the husband and wife, watching their sweetly babbling infant crawl about on His knees, were filled with great joy.
2. On His smiling face, like a red lotus, shone the rays of "the king of the twice-born"¹, dispelling the darkness in the minds of the saints.
3. "He has sustained the universe from of old," thought the father, and he himself gave Him the most beautiful name Sriman Vishvambhara².
4. Hari's body gleamed like molten gold, His eyes were wide as shining lotuses; clad only in the wind, He wore a silver necklace and a garland in His curls.
5. His face was like the full moon, His babble sweet as nectar; bracelets on His wrists and armlets on His arms adorned the charming child.
6. Pure, His palms and soles red as a lotus or ground vermillion, He grew day by day, waxing digit by digit like the moon in the bright fortnight.
7. In time the infant of boundless radiance began to walk, and treading with His red feet He soothed the earth's burning, born of separation (from Him)³.
8. Janardana ate the food of a brahmana who wandered among the holy places, and so reminded him of the wonder in the house of Nanda⁴.
9. He played with the boys of His age, (swinging) shoots of trees, and the children, struck by them, all romped joyfully before Him.
10. Hari, a child by His own maya, played like a monkey: standing on one foot, He would touch another boy's knee with His knee.
11. Once, seeing His mother angrily about to seize Him, He grew angry Himself and smashed the pots.
12. He whom Yashoda once bound with cattle ropes for a broken pot⁵ — Him Shachi now feared: looking at His face, she trembled.
13. Then He sat down in an impure place, on a heap of discarded clay pots piled one upon another, and laughed in front of His mother.
14. Seeing this, Shachi said: "Child, come away from that loathsome place! Bathe again, be clean, and climb onto my lap."
15. At these words Bhagavan, the knower of all truths, wholly imbued with the mood of Dattatreya⁶, who completes (the knowledge) of the all-knowing, answered her:
16. "Listen: pure and impure are mere notions of the mind. For the world is (only) earth, water, air, fire, ether and mind; and here shines only the one Hari, the ocean of compassion, whose lotus feet are non-dual and prior to all the outspread manifestation. Know that there is nothing else.
17. Therefore I am pure and in no way impure. Know this, mother, and harbour no other doubt here."
18. When her son had spoken thus, she hastily took Him by the hand, led Him (to the river) and bathed Him in the clear waters of the heavenly river.
19. After some time Shachi again saw her son seated on a heap of thrown-away clay pots and scolded Him:
20. "Foolish one! Why do you sit in an impure, forbidden place?" Hearing these words of His mother, filled with anger,

21. Sriman Vishvambhara said: "Foolish woman! There is nothing impure anywhere. I told you this before — so why do you reproach Me?"
22. With these words He angrily threw a brick at her face. Stricken by the blow, she fainted and fell.
23. Then all the women gathered and sprinkled her with cool water. And then Hari, who acts in human ways, came there
24. and at once burst into tears Himself: "Mother, mother!" — and laid on her face His beautiful hand, which takes away every sorrow.
25. Shachi came to herself at once, took her son onto her lap and, beside herself with love for him, rejoiced with all her heart.
26. Then a merry woman, fond of a joke, said to the Teacher of the world: "Go and fetch two coconuts for your mother,
27. bring them and give them to her — then she will be well. If not, she will die — and what will you do then?"
28. Hearing her words, He (slipped down) from His mother's lap⁷, went out, brought and gave two coconuts.
29. Hari brought a pair of coconuts whose stalks still glistened with sap, as if they had just fallen. The astonished women asked: "Where did you get this fruit?"
30. Then the great-hearted (boy), the banner of the Vatsa clan⁸, silenced them all with a fierce "hum!" and turned His smiling lotus face to His mother.
31. Now hear more of the wonderful deeds of the Great Soul — the Supreme Self, the Lord of maya: excellent deeds, beyond all that is worldly.
32. One night Shachi, having fallen asleep, noticed that the house seemed full of people; alarmed, she took her son, who lay on her lap,
33. and in fear hastily sent Sriman Vishvambhara Hari to her husband's room; and on the way the gods worshipped Him⁹.
34. As the son walked there, the jingling of ankle bells came again and again from His bare feet. Hearing it, the alarmed Vatsya asked Shachi, and Shachi the Vatsya: "What is this? Where does this sound come from?"
35. When the son came near, the brahmana saw in great amazement that his son's lotus feet were quite bare. "Then where did the sweet jingling of ankle bells come from?" (he wondered) — and, embracing his son, he was filled with joy.

Thus ends the sixth sarga, "The Description of the Pastimes from Birth among the Childhood Plays" (Balya-krida: janmadi-lila-varnana), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. "The king of the twice-born" (dvijaraja) is the moon; but "the twice-born" (dvija) are also the teeth: a play on words — the shining of His teeth in His smile.
2. Vishvambhara means "He who sustains the universe."
3. The earth, according to tradition, suffered in separation from Krishna's feet after His departure.
4. The story of the pilgrim brahmana whose food, offered to the Lord, was eaten by the infant Nimai; so too the infant Krishna once ate the food of a wandering brahmana in the house of Nanda.
5. An allusion to the Bhagavata Purana (10.9): Yashoda bound the child Krishna when He broke the pot of curd.
6. Dattatreya is an incarnation of the Lord, an avadhuta who made no distinction between pure and impure.
7. The end of the line is corrupt in the sources; the reading is tentative.
8. The Vatsa clan (gotra) is the clan of Jagannatha Mishra (cf. "the Vatsya").

Prakrama 1, Sarga 7. The Childhood Plays

The story of Vishvarupa: his sannyasa and the parents' blessing; Vishvambhara's promise to serve his parents; His pranks and the dream of Jagannatha Mishra; Vishvambhara asks His mother not to eat on Ekadashi; the question of Damodara

1. Having heard this, and blissful in meditation on Hari's lotus feet, Damodara asked to hear the holy story of Hari's elder brother:
2. "Tell me truly the great and renowned story of Vishvarupa." Hearing this, (Murari) replied: "Listen, O brahmana, and I shall tell you."
3. With these words the physician¹ began the heart-charming, auspicious and purifying story of Vishvarupa, the portion of Baladeva.
4. Sriman Sri Vishvarupa, a treasury of every virtue, utterly pure, became an acharya at sixteen by hearing of the Self and reflecting upon it. Of powerful intellect, a devotee full of love, all-knowing, he was ever joyful, his heart clinging to the feet of Narahari; peaceful and content, unattached to the world, he knew the Vedas and knew rasa.
5. In private the father was considering a suitable bride for his son; but the brahmana's son himself came to know all that he was pondering in his heart.
6. Learning thus all his father's hidden intentions, the forbearing Vishvarupa left home, crossed the heavenly river and took sannyasa, which others cannot attain.
7. When he heard of this, the father was overwhelmed, and the virtuous mother wept bitterly. But then both, wishing their son well, said: "May our son remain true to the dharma of sannyasa!"
8. Having given their son this blessing, both kept their fortitude like sages; casting off grief, they took their son — the Lord of the world — onto their laps and at once were filled with joy.
9. Then Hari said: "Father, My brother has left you and gone far away. It is I who will serve you and mother — and may you always be happy."
10. Hearing such words from their son — weighty, deep, charming and full of meaning — the mother and father embraced Him and, with tears of joy in their eyes, were filled with delight.
11. Their limbs were sated with the sweetness of His touch; bathed in tears, they knew nothing else — as accomplished yogis, absorbed in their own yoga, see neither this world nor the next.
12. He studied, serving His father with all His heart, yet He was also caught up in play among a band of boys: romping with His companions, grey with dust, even when hungry He forgot all about food.
13. Once, seeing his son so wilful, the father, wishing Him well, scolded Him: "You have thrown aside your lessons and everything else, and you play with the boys though you are hungry!"
14. Then at night, toward dawn, the foremost of the best brahmanas appeared to him in a dream and said: "Do you not value your son? Or are you like a beast that knows nothing of the worth of a touchstone?"
15. Deck a beast's body in jewelled silks — will it not chew those silks?"² Mishra fearlessly replied: "Even if my son is Narayana Himself,
16. still it is my duty to punish Him." To this the brahmana said: "Rightly spoken." With these words the foremost of brahmanas departed, and the Vatsya, waking, told (of the dream).

17. Hearing of the dream, the people rejoiced and joyfully saw in Vishvambhara, the best of the best, the fulfilment of their hopes; but the father considered Him his own son, and the mother was content.
18. Once, when He was at home, His body, red as the rays of the rising sun, blazed with its own light, and He said: "Mother, do as I tell you."
19. Seeing her son blazing with His own light, the frightened and astonished mother said: "Child, whatever you say I shall do; tell me yourself what is on your mind."
20. Hearing these words, sweet as nectar, He said to her: "Mother, on the day of Hari you must not eat."³ Hearing her son, she gladly agreed: "So be it."
21. Then, having eaten the betel nut and other things that a certain brahmana had offered (to the Lord), He spoke to her again: "I am going. Guard the body of your son, which for half a moment will lie motionless."
22. So saying, He suddenly rose and fell to the ground like a stick. Thinking that Vishvambhara had left her, the mother, in deep grief,
23. bathed Him with the waters of the Ganga, which are like nectar. Then He awoke, recovered and lived happily again,
24. shining with His natural radiance. Hearing of this, the astonished Jagannatha said: "We do not understand this divine maya."
25. Hearing this wondrous story, the brahmana Damodara said: "What is this you have told, good friend? Krishna Himself, the teacher of the world,
26. was born (here) — how then could He say to His mother, 'I am going; guard your son, good lady'? About this I have a great doubt.
27. Is this the maya of the Lord of the world? Please explain it — for the deeds of Hari are done for the good of the world."

Thus ends the seventh sarga, "The Childhood Plays" (Balya-krida), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Murari Gupta was a physician (vaidya) by caste and occupation.

2. The sense: you do not value your son, as a beast knows the worth neither of the touchstone nor of precious silk.

3. The lunar day of Hari is Ekadashi, the eleventh day of the lunar fortnight, a fast day.

Prakrama 1, Sarga 8. The Passing of Jagannatha Mishra

Murari's answer: the Lord enters the devotee's heart, and the devotee takes on His form (the examples of Prahlada, the gopis and Narada); Vishvambhara's studies; the illness and passing of Jagannatha Mishra on the bank of the Ganga; the funeral rites

1. Having heard him, (Murari) thought and reflected, bowed to Hari and spoke again: "Listen with all your attention.
2. When a person meditates on Bhagavan, sings His kirtana and hears (of Him), Hari enters the heart of that great soul.
3. And then he imitates Him: forgetting his own body and all the rest, he constantly bears within him His splendour and His might.
4. So it is for a time; and then he returns to outer consciousness and does his ordinary acts — as once Prahlada did:

5. in the ocean he became identified (with the Lord), and on the shore the remembrance of his body returned¹. So indeed the virtuous gopis too at times experience such identification².
6. The Lord did this to teach the world a lesson: for a devotee of Krishna there can be such identity of form (with Him).
7. And so that people here should not be bewildered, He taught: the devotee's body is truly the very self of Bhagavan; of this there is no doubt.
8. Krishna, having slain Keshi, showed Narada His glory and His power; and then the best of sages
9. fell to the ground like a stick. And a Vaishnava who goes to the city of Mathura obtains at that place a hundredfold greater reward³.
10. So too Rama, the source of the world, showed His universal form to Shiva, and then again performed human deeds⁴.
11. Now, O brahmana, hear further the auspicious story of Chaitanya: whoever hears it with faith, though mortal, is freed from the bondage of worldly existence.
12. Living in the house of His teacher, the Victorious One studied all the Vedas, and then He Himself, the husband of Sarasvati⁵, taught students.
13. His father too, greatly fortunate, happily studied the Vedanta and other scriptures. And when Jagannatha, the bull among brahmanas, had returned (home),
14. by the will of fate a life-taking fever came upon him. Seeing His father in such a state, Hari Himself, together with His mother,
15. went to the bank of the Jahnavi — the beautiful Lord Vishvambhara, surrounded by His devotees absorbed in the kirtana of Hari.
16. Then Hari embraced both His father's feet and said in a faltering voice: 'Father, My master! Where are you going, leaving Me so soon?'
17. He lovingly drank in with his ears the nectar of his son's words and replied: 'I have entrusted You wholly to the feet of Raghunatha.'⁶
18. By day, when the host of the best gods with Mahendra had appeared in the sky and the people were absorbed in the sankirtana of Hari, the best of brahmanas, standing in the waters of the heavenly river,
19. left his body, mounted the chariot of the heaven-dwellers and went to the abode of Hari. Though the body of that great soul is eternally perfect, he (showed death) at his own will, so that his conduct might serve the good of the world.
20. Then Shachi, utterly broken by grief, lamented her husband who had attained perfection; surrounded by a crowd of women, she fell at the feet of her lord and cried out like an osprey.
21. As the ocean of mercy wept again and again for His father, streams of tears fell from His eyes; leaving on His chest a trace like a necklace of elephant-pearls⁷, they shone.
22. Then, consoled by His relatives, the Lord, full of grief, performed together with the brahmanas all the holy rites fitting for the end of life, according to the injunctions.
23. As if downcast, loving His father, He performed with the accumulated wealth the sacrifice to the ancestors, and then in due order the holy rite of honouring the brahmanas, presenting them with land and other gifts⁸.
24. Whoever tirelessly tells thus of the departure to heaven of the Lord's father will attain the heavenly river and, swiftly casting off impurity, will go to the abode of Hari."

Thus ends the eighth sarga, "The Passing of Jagannatha Mishra" (Jagannatha-mishra-samsiddhi), of the first prakrama of the great poem "Sri Krishna-chaitanya-charitamrita."

1. Prahlada, thrown into the ocean at Hiranyakashipu's command, became absorbed in meditation on the Lord and felt himself one with Him; on the shore he again became aware of his body.
2. The gopis, in separation from Krishna, imitated His pastimes, identifying themselves with Him.
3. The place where the demon Keshi was slain in Vrindavana is revered as holy (Keshi-ghat).
4. Rama is Ramachandra, the avatara of Vishnu; Shiva is His great worshipper.
5. The husband of Sarasvati (the goddess of learning) — the Lord as master of all knowledge.
6. Raghunatha ("Lord of the Raghus") is Ramachandra.
7. By poetic convention, pearls are born in the foreheads of elephants.
8. The sense of the word "dharadibhajanaih" is unclear; the translation is tentative.